

# THE FRIEND THEY MOURNED (FOUR KEYS)

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## THE SPINE, v1.2

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*2026-08-30. Pipeline step 1, step 1b with the recipient column, and step 2. Written against premise v8 (closed to premise attack), the five v1.2, and the Four Keys rulings in memory. No prose. Nothing in this document reaches Fable except Part G.*

**v1.1, same day: all eight rulings in Part E taken by Stephen.** Seven went the way the spine asked. Ruling 8 went a different and better way: Brad does not live under a dead infant's record, he lives under the genuine name of a man he killed three years before Violet, whose body was never found and whose file is low risk with no sample under R16. That adds one node (the lodger, the skipper who reported him, the constable who called) to Parts A, B and C, and it changes "who Brad is": Violet was not his first. The sweep was re-run on the new node and still passes.  $\Delta$  Premise v8's "Who Brad is" and the settled line "documents never his" now need a one-line update; that is Stephen's document and is flagged, not edited.

**Status: the sweep PASSES.** No person's earliest competent action ends the episode before its planned turn. Two locks are thin and are named as such in Part C: Margo's six days between her turn and Brad's vanish, and Ruby's open route to Del from Day 27, which is open, computed, and does not deliver.

**Two objects chosen here (Part D).** X, what Violet hid, is a gilded alphabet panel Brad made in a hand he had never shown anyone, signed with a mark that is not his name. The decoy is the boat name board from her hall, Liam's gift from the yard, taken by Brad on Day 0 from the one place none of the four had been in the nineteen days before she died. Fable's brush, sable on an oar handle, fails three of the seven constraints as X and fails as decoy because the whole town saw her use it until the day she died; it stays as texture.

**v1.2, same evening: ChatGPT's step-3 attack returned REWORK with ten findings.** Eight accepted and repaired here, one answered from the ledger (7), one contested and then closed by a new ruling, R27, that a canvass of a document's finding place needs a tampering hypothesis (5). Findings and disposition: four-keys-spine-attack-chatgpt-2026-08-30.md. The two repairs that matter: the decoy changed (finding 1) and the lodger's file no longer names Brad's flat and no document carries Brad's face (finding 4). Weekdays corrected (finding 2). The sweep still passes.

**Decided here, from v8's open list:** the motive (the money, below) · the cupboard (Violet's storage cage, Bay 4, the back corridor of the fish market) · the meeting room (Ruby's kitchen) · the cliff (Kestrel Head, the drop beyond Kestrel Point Lighthouse at the end of Kestrel Road; canon landmark, cliff not yet built) · the source of Violet's money (her mother's cash, taken from the house the week she died, told only to Margo) · the span (Day 0 to Day 333, with Brad's first preparation at Day -900) · which survivor comes to Ally (Ruby first, Liam by episode four) · neither survivor is anything to Ally already.

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## THE GRAPH, IN ONE TABLE

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*The whole truth, once, so every later part can be checked against it. Everything below is known in full only to Brad.*

| What actually happened                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Day            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| A deckhand who lives aboard his skipper's boat drinks at Brad's flat and keeps a dry bag there. No family, nobody who would look. After a night's drinking at the flat, Brad walks him to Kestrel Head and pushes him. The body is never found. The skipper reports him when he misses a sailing; the file names the boat as his address and never names Brad. Low risk, no sample (R16). The bag, with his papers, is Brad's. | -1500 to -1090 |
| Brad builds the exit on the dead man's genuine name and puts his own face on nothing: no licence renewal, no bank, no register. A room paid in cash, a workshop paid in cash, a prepaid. The name is inert on every system from Day -1090. No accomplice, no seller.                                                                                                                                                           | -900 to -500   |
| He hollows the trade: cash where offered, declared turnover falling year on year. The pub that changes its name every spring pays him cash at his request.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | -850 onward    |
| He rents a room 400 miles away, cash, quarterly in advance, as a lodger in a widow's house. Weekend absences begin, told as customers up the coast.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | -400           |
| He makes the panel on Tuesday nights at Violet's bench after she has gone, and keeps it in the roof space over her paint racks, because his flat and van must stay clean.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | -380 to -80    |
| Violet tells Margo she is calling in what she is owed, for the lawyer in the fight with her sister. The largest debt is Brad's: the van and first stock, cash, no paper, from Day -2000. She tells Brad on Day -110.                                                                                                                                                                                                           | -120           |
| Brad decides she dies before he goes. From inside: a debt follows a man who moves and not a man who dies; a man who dies needs a grief; hers is the one grief that makes his vanish read true; and she has never cost him anything he valued.                                                                                                                                                                                  | -110           |
| A roof leak. Violet finds the wrapped panel above the racks. She carries it round town for a month asking whose hand. Brad hears from the café on Day -40.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | -75            |
| The ladder. Brad undoes the foot bolt of the Regent ladder the night before; she falls from the third rung; hip; Ruby treats it at the surgery. Violet finds the bolt undone, not sheared, and tells nobody.                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | -45            |
| Violet changes the cage padlock, has four keys cut on Lantern Street, writes five letters, hides panel and letter in the cage, lodges four envelopes with her solicitor: post after my funeral.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | -20 to -18     |
| Brad walks to Mariner's Row about the money. She goes up for the debt book. The stairs. He waits twenty minutes, takes the book, leaves by the back lane.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 0              |
| Accident. The four keys. Brad reads the cage on Day 16, writes at her bench on Day 17, swaps on Day 18. The panel leaves with him on Day 53 in a bag hidden at the ridge wall.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 1 to 53        |
| He contacts Margo from a cash prepaid on the channel she uses for Tessa, walks 19 miles in from the inland halt on Day 214, and pushes her from the point. Her phone and his prepaid go into the sea.                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 180 to 215     |
| Ally arrives after the front page. Her listeners find the pieces. The panel is described on air on Day 325 and is gone from his wall by Day 326. His landlady writes that night. The reference sample taken to identify his body identifies him alive.                                                                                                                                                                         | 266 to 333     |

## A. THE CLOCK

Day 0 is the Monday Violet dies. Negative days precede it. Times are given where they matter. Weeks in Part C: Week 1 = Days 0 to 6.

### A1. Before

| Day   | Event                                                                                                                                                 | Who knows                                  |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| -2000 | Violet lends Brad the van and first stock from the tin. No paper. She asks Margo whether a loan needs paper; Margo says yes; Violet does not.         | Violet, Brad, Margo                        |
| -1500 | Violet's mother dies; Liam drives them in the last night. Violet clears the house first and takes the cash her mother kept. The sister does not know. | Violet; Liam knows the night, not the cash |

| Day            | Event                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Who knows                                                     |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| -1450          | Violet asks Margo whether cash from her mother is taxable. Margo notes it in her own file. This is the only record of where the money came from.                                                                                                                           | Violet, Margo                                                 |
| -1200          | The sister moves to sell the house. The dispute begins. Violet instructs a solicitor on Civic Row.                                                                                                                                                                         | Violet, sister, solicitor, later all four                     |
| -1800 →        | Brad practises Violet's cursive on Tuesday nights at her bench from her job notes, and burns the sheets. A private exercise nobody sees.                                                                                                                                   | Brad                                                          |
| -1500          | A deckhand, about Brad's age, who lives aboard his skipper's boat, starts drinking at Brad's flat and keeps a dry bag there with his papers. No family.                                                                                                                    | Brad; the skipper knows he drinks "at a mate's" and not whose |
| -1100          | A bottle at the flat, two men, nobody else. Brad walks him to Kestrel Head and pushes him. No body. The bag stays at the flat.                                                                                                                                             | Brad                                                          |
| -1090          | The skipper reports him missing when he misses a sailing. Last address: the boat. Enquiries: the harbour master, the pub (he was not there that night). Adult, itinerant, no dependants: low risk, closed as drifted. No sample (R16). Brad's name is nowhere on the file. | HCPD file (Harbor Ward), skipper                              |
| -900 →<br>-500 | The exit, on the dead man's name, with Brad's face on nothing: the genuine passport and birth certificate in a drawer, never presented; a room and a workshop paid in cash; a prepaid.                                                                                     | Brad                                                          |
| -850 →         | Cash where offered. The pub landlord pays cash from Day -700 at Brad's request. Declared turnover falls.                                                                                                                                                                   | Brad; the pub landlord; Margo sees the pub's side of it       |
| -600           | Violet notices Margo has a Sunday, and a green app she checks at the slip. She says so to Brad, the only one she talks to about the other three.                                                                                                                           | Violet, Brad                                                  |
| -400           | Brad rents the room, cash, quarterly, as a lodger. Weekend absences begin.                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Brad; the landlady knows a lodger under the other name        |
| -380 →<br>-80  | The panel, Tuesday nights at Violet's bench after she leaves, kept in the roof space over the racks.                                                                                                                                                                       | Brad                                                          |
| -250           | Brad runs a marathon in another city under three hours and tells the four it was a wedding.                                                                                                                                                                                | Brad; Ruby sees the result page on Day -200 and says nothing  |
| -200           | In the crane cab Brad asks Liam what the yard would give for the van, cash, spring maybe.                                                                                                                                                                                  | Brad, Liam                                                    |
| -120           | Violet tells Margo she is calling in what she is owed. The list, in Violet's hand, names Brad and the sum.                                                                                                                                                                 | Violet, Margo                                                 |
| -110           | Violet tells Brad. Brad decides.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Violet, Brad                                                  |
| -75            | The leak. Violet finds the panel.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Violet                                                        |
| -70 →<br>-40   | Violet shows the panel to the cinema owner, the café, two other signwriters on the coast: whose hand is this.                                                                                                                                                              | Those four people; Brad from the café on Day -40              |
| -46<br>night   | Brad, with his unit key, undoes the foot bolt on the Regent ladder.                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Brad                                                          |
| -45            | Violet falls from the third rung onto the cobbles. Hip. Ruby treats her at Wharf Street and records a fall from a ladder. Violet finds the bolt undone.                                                                                                                    | Violet, Ruby (the fall only)                                  |
| -20            | New padlock on Cage 4. Four keys cut at the locksmith on Lantern Street; his book records four copies, that date.                                                                                                                                                          | Violet, locksmith                                             |
| -19            | Violet writes four key letters and one cage letter, hides panel and letter in the cage.                                                                                                                                                                                    | Violet                                                        |
| -18            | She lodges four sealed envelopes with the solicitor: post these after my funeral. He asks; she makes a joke about her sister.                                                                                                                                              | Violet, solicitor                                             |
| -18 →<br>-1    | Nothing visible. Tuesday visits, the slip, the receipts bag.                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                               |

## A2. The death and the keys

| Day       | Time  | Event                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0<br>Mon  | 21:30 | Brad walks to Mariner's Row, phone left at his flat. She lets him in. The money.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 0         | 21:55 | She goes up for the debt book. He follows. The landing, the light off. One push.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 0         | 22:20 | She stops breathing at the foot of the stairs. He has not touched her again. He takes the book, and the boat name board off its hook in the hall.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 0         | 22:30 | Out by the back door, latched behind him. The neighbour at N°14 sees a man's back in the lane with a flat thing under his arm and thinks nothing.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 1<br>Tue  | 06:00 | Ruby's text, then Ruby's car at the slip. No Violet. Ruby assumes the Regent ladder, early.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 1         | 12:30 | Liam at the unit. Shut.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 1         | 13:10 | Liam at the house with the spare key. Finds her. 13:14 he rings it in.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 1         | 14:00 | Uniform, then the Harbor Ward sergeant (Del) at a sudden death: unwitnessed, head injury, foot of the stairs, front locked, back latched, no disturbance, two glasses of wine on the side. Coroner's officer informed. Door-knock: N°14 saw her Monday morning, and a man's back in the lane about half ten, carrying something flat. Noted: unidentified male, lane, approx 22:30. Nothing to identify him against. Scene photographs include the hall: an empty hook and a pale rectangle on the wall, which nobody reads. |
| 2         |       | Liam into the unit, heater off, finds the tin. Rings the sister. Ruby reads Violet's record at the surgery: the ladder fall.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 3         |       | Post-mortem (Cortez): skull fracture and brain injury consistent with a fall down a domestic stair; healed bruising to the hip; blood alcohol modest. GP record shows a fall six weeks earlier.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 5         |       | The sister arrives. Liam hands her the tin in front of Ruby and Margo. All four now know of the tin.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 6         |       | Coroner opens and adjourns. Body released.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 11<br>Fri |       | Funeral. The wake photograph: the four together.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 12<br>Sat |       | The solicitor posts four envelopes.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 14<br>Mon |       | Four keys and four letters arrive. The letter says: I think one of you is planning to kill me, I do not know which, I may be wrong, do not go to the police and here is why, what I found is behind this door, only the four of you can read it. Cage 4 is named. They ring each other that night and agree Saturday.                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 16<br>Wed | 05:40 | Brad at Cage 4, market hours, van in the loading bay. Reads the cage letter, takes it and the panel. The fishmonger at Bay 3 says early for you.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 17<br>Thu | night | Brad at Violet's bench with his unit key. Her layout paper, her pen. He writes it there, where practice sheets in her style are invisible among her own, with the debt book open beside him for her cursive. Burns the drafts and the book in his sink. Puts the pen back.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 18<br>Fri | 05:30 | Brad places the letter and the name board in Cage 4.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 19<br>Sat | 10:00 | The four open Cage 4. A letter in her hand that says I know, and the name board from her hall. Read at Ruby's kitchen table. Margo asks why the board is here and is answered: she is telling us something. Brad says she might have been wrong about all of it. Weekly meetings agreed.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

## A3. The room

| Day | Event                                                             |
|-----|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 26  | Meeting 2. The letter's line about the yard is read against Liam. |

| Day             | Event                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 27              | Liam confirms he owns a third of the yard. A fact in the letter is true. Ruby is shaken. Margo, who did not know, says nothing about the money she does know.                                                                                                                          |
| 33              | Meeting 3. The tin. The letter says the money is Liam's, paid quarterly since the yard. Liam: I never gave her a penny. Brad: she might have been wrong about the money, and if she was wrong about that she was wrong about the rest; we cannot do this to Liam on a maybe. He loses. |
| 40              | Meeting 4. The ladder. The letter says she had told Liam which ladder. Liam: she told everyone which ladder. Margo begins the sums.                                                                                                                                                    |
| 44              | Margo opens her own file. Day –1450, in her hand: cash, mother, no tax. The letter has the money wrong. Violet did not lie to them. So the letter is not Violet's. So somebody wrote it, before Saturday, and left a real thing of hers beside it.                                     |
| 45 to 47        | The sums at three in the morning come out the same. The one person who kept the room on Liam by defending him.                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 46              | Brad had already placed the bag at the ridge wall: clothes, cash, the panel wrapped, on a customer run. Ready since Day 30. Margo is the trigger, not the plan.                                                                                                                        |
| 47              | Meeting 5. Margo stops arguing with Brad and stops looking at the other two. Brad notices.                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 53 Fri<br>22:40 | Van to the Kestrel Head car park. 23:12 one message to the group thread: I can't do this any more. I'm sorry. Phone on the seat. The watch, smashed with a stone, thrown to the rocks. 23:30 the coast path inland, then the ridge path.                                               |
| 54 Sat<br>05:47 | First train from the inland halt, cash single. 15:00 at the lodgings, a job that ran late.                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 54<br>06:30     | A dog walker finds the van. Police. Del. Coastguard search Days 54 to 56. Flat searched Day 54 evening: passport, cards, tools, laptop, all present.                                                                                                                                   |
| 55              | Watch found at the base. Reference sample: toothbrush, razor, prints lifted from the flat. Missing person, high risk, presumed in the water. Interviews Days 55 to 56: Ruby, Liam, Margo, each says grief. None mentions the letters.                                                  |
| 57 →            | The three keep meeting. Ruby drives it.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 70              | Margo to Tessa on the app: the thing in the cupboard is wrong. It can't mean that. Tessa screenshots it because Margo does not say things like that.                                                                                                                                   |
| 82              | The sister, clearing the unit, cuts the padlock on Cage 4. Empty.                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 84              | Brad's rent stops.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 89              | It lands. Ruby says it to Liam's face. Liam leaves and does not come back.                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 110             | The landlord clears the flat. Boxes to Ruby.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 90 →<br>213     | Liam and Ruby do not speak. Margo withdraws from Ruby. Margo drives to Tessa every second Sunday.                                                                                                                                                                                      |

## A4. The stranger, the return, the second death

| Day              | Event                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 180              | A new contact on the green app, from a number that leads nowhere: you're the one who stopped believing the letter. Brad has her number from the group and knew the app from Violet.                                                                                                                |
| 180 →<br>212     | He knows the wording of the message, the watch, the time on the car park clock. He says Brad was not alone that night. Everything points her away from Brad and towards the woman who ran every meeting. Everything deletes. Margo does not turn: she keeps arriving at the man who defended Liam. |
| 212 Wed          | Friday. The point. Eleven. I'll show you where he went down and you'll see it isn't what they said.                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 213 Thu          | Brad tells the landlady a job away Friday to Saturday. Train south, cash, two changes.                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 214 Fri<br>17:10 | The last train of the day reaches the inland halt. He walks the ridge path, 19 miles.                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 214              | Margo tells nobody. Tessa expects her on Sunday, as every second Sunday.                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 214<br>22:50     | Margo's car in the Kestrel Head car park, ten minutes early. She sits in the car until the hour.                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

| Day              | Event                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 214<br>23:00     | The point. He asks to see what he sent her. She hands him the phone. He pockets it.                                                                                                                      |
| 214<br>23:10     | She goes over. Her phone and his prepaid off the point into deep water at 23:20.                                                                                                                         |
| 215 Sat<br>05:47 | The first train. The clerk sells a cash single to a man with wet boots and complains about the change. A woman on the platform notices the boots.                                                        |
| 215<br>06:40     | The same dog walker finds the car. Police. Search.                                                                                                                                                       |
| 215              | Margo's office is shut; nobody expects her until Monday. Her sister is not in the story; her office manager is rung by police from the car's registration on Saturday afternoon and knows of no partner. |
| 216 Sun<br>11:00 | Margo does not arrive at Tessa's; unanswered since Friday. 14:00 Tessa rings Havenbay police: a partner nobody in Havenbay knew.                                                                         |
| 215              | Del pulls Brad's file beside it: two of Violet Moore's four, same car park, five months apart.                                                                                                           |
| 218              | Margo's body in Havenbay harbour. Post-mortem: injuries fully explained by the fall and the water.                                                                                                       |
| 219 →<br>221     | Del interviews Liam and Ruby as Margo's friends. Each, separately, frightened, hands over the letters and says: I am frightened of him. I am frightened of her.                                          |
| 222              | Formal statements. Three deaths, five letters, two survivors. The detective division takes it with Del attached.                                                                                         |
| 225              | Margo's carrier records: Tessa's town, the road home, the car park at 22:40, no signal after 23:20. Data sessions only.                                                                                  |
| 230 →<br>250     | The cage letter examined against the four key letters and her unit paper: consistent with known samples, same paper stock.                                                                               |
| 235              | Solicitor confirms lodging on Day -18. Her fear predates her death.                                                                                                                                      |
| 240              | App provider: account exists, no content retained, no contact metadata. Tessa re-interviewed: gives the line about the cupboard; read as Margo doubting the reading, which fits Liam's account.          |
| 245              | Coroner's officer asked to look again at Violet: no new physical evidence, finding stands. Brad's file: no change.                                                                                       |
| 262              | No further action. Both survivors informed.                                                                                                                                                              |
| 263              | Ruby talks to the Gazette.                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 265              | Front page: the four friends of Violet Moore, the wake photograph. Liam, doorstepped: ask her who ran the meetings.                                                                                      |

## A5. Ally

| Day | Ep | Event                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 266 |    | Ally reads it. Del: we looked. Properly. There's nothing.                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 269 | 1  | Ally has the paper, Ruby's willingness, and Del's nothing.                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 276 | 2  | Ruby: the room, the letters read out, the boxes, Brad's habits: keys on the table moved twice, thank you like it cost him, up at five to run.                                                                                                                                          |
| 283 | 3  | The café and the cinema owner: she was calling money in; and she was carrying a gold panel round asking whose hand it was. Ally does not know what that means. The download map shows a listener in a town 400 miles away from this week.                                              |
| 290 | 4  | Liam talks. The fishmonger at Bay 3 rings the Tip Line: the young one was at her cage on the Wednesday. Ally gives it to Del and does not air it.                                                                                                                                      |
| 297 | 5  | Ally asks: did Margo say anything to anyone.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 300 |    | Tessa writes, with the screenshot.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 304 | 6  | The words go on air, from a woman two hours up the coast: the thing in the cupboard is wrong. Ally: if the thing was wrong there was a real thing, and nobody has found one. What did Violet have in her last months that she hadn't before. Two signwriters write in about the panel. |

| Day          | Ep | Event                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 311          | 7  | I think against I know. The solicitor's slip dates the first. The letter that is kind to exactly one man.                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 311          |    | The skipper writes: the deckhand who lodged with Brad Collins went missing three years before Violet. To Del, never aired: it points at a dead man as a killer, not at a living one.                                                                                                  |
| 318          | 8  | The woman from the platform writes: the first train, the Monday the car was found, wet boots, cash. To Del, not on air. Ally asks: if you were on that train, write to me.                                                                                                            |
| 325          | 9  | The panel described: black ground, twenty-six gold capitals and an ampersand, a crack across one corner, a small mark bottom right that was not her name and not his. One of a kind.                                                                                                  |
| 325 night    |    | Brad takes it off the wall and burns it in the workshop stove.                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 326          |    | The landlady, who has listened since Day 283, who half-saw the wake photograph online on Day 266 and dismissed it for the beard, who has heard six weeks of his habits from strangers, dusts his room on a Tuesday. Gone. She writes to Ally that night, privately, with her address. |
| 327          |    | Ally to Del, 07:00. Del to the other force.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 328 →<br>332 |    | He notices her.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 332          | 10 | Indistinguishable from episode nine.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 333          |    | Arrest on the identity offences. The other force runs the name: a low-risk missing-person file in Harbor Ward, three years before Violet, last address Brad Collins's flat. Prints against the Day 55 reference. Brad Collins, alive.                                                 |

## B. THE ACCESS LEDGER

One row per fact. Columns: fact · who holds it · from when · by what route · who they could lawfully tell · the recipient's earliest competent action on that fact alone. "Nobody" in the tell column means a duty of confidence or no lawful audience; "anyone" means it is not confidential.

### B1. Facts that exist before Day 0

| # | Fact                                                     | Holder                                                       | From            | Route                                                                           | Could tell                              | Recipient's earliest action |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| 1 | Violet holds cash, in a tin, more than painting explains | Violet, Margo, Brad (the tin, not the size), Liam from Day 2 | Day −1500       | Violet's own act; Margo told for the tax question; Brad saw the tin at the unit | Anyone; Margo owes confidence           | None: cash is lawful        |
| 2 | The cash came from her mother's house                    | Violet, Margo                                                | Day −1450       | Violet told Margo; Margo's file note                                            | Margo: nobody, without Violet's consent | None                        |
| 3 | Violet lent Brad the van money, no paper                 | Violet, Brad, Margo                                          | Day −2000       | Violet told Margo                                                               | Margo: nobody                           | None                        |
| 4 | Violet is calling in every debt, Brad's the largest      | Violet, Margo, Brad                                          | Day −120 / −110 | Told directly                                                                   | Margo: nobody                           | None                        |



| #   | Fact                                                                                                                              | Holder                                                                                           | From                                      | Route                                                  | Could tell                                                                            | Recipient's earliest action                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 5   | Liam owns a third of the yard                                                                                                     | Liam, Violet, Brad                                                                               | Day -2900; Brad from Day -500             | Liam told Violet; Violet told Brad                     | Anyone: a lawful private shareholding; the yard's register is not public              | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 5a  | The boat name board in Violet's hall was Liam's gift from the yard, eight years ago, off the first boat lifted after he bought in | The four (they have all seen it in her hall); Brad knows the provenance and the date from Violet | Day -2900; Brad from Day -500             | Violet told Brad the story; the others saw the board   | Anyone                                                                                | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 5b  | Nobody but Brad was inside Violet's house between Day -19 and Day 0                                                               | Brad                                                                                             | Day 0                                     | Her visits happen at the unit and the slip             | Nobody                                                                                | The board's absence from the hall cannot be dated by any of the four                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 6   | Margo has a partner two hours up the coast and an app for her                                                                     | Margo, Tessa; Violet (a Sunday and a green app, no name); Brad from Violet                       | Day -4000; Violet Day -600; Brad Day -500 | Observation; Violet to Brad                            | Anyone                                                                                | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 7   | Brad's declared turnover is falling while the van stays busy                                                                      | Brad; the pub landlord (his own payments); Margo (the pub's books)                               | Day -700                                  | Margo does the pub's accounts                          | Margo: her client's affairs are confidential; a cash payment to a tradesman is lawful | None: nothing to report                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 8   | Brad told the four a wedding; it was a marathon                                                                                   | Brad; Ruby                                                                                       | Day -250 / -200                           | A patient's son showed Ruby the results page           | Anyone                                                                                | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 9   | Brad asked Liam what the yard would give for the van                                                                              | Brad, Liam                                                                                       | Day -200                                  | Direct                                                 | Anyone                                                                                | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 10  | Brad has a room, a name, and papers 400 miles away                                                                                | Brad; the landlady knows a lodger under the other name                                           | Day -400                                  | His own act                                            | The landlady: anyone; she has nothing to say                                          | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 10a | A deckhand went missing from his skipper's boat three years before Violet                                                         | HCPD (a low-risk MP file, last address the boat, no mention of Brad); the skipper                | Day -1090                                 | The skipper's report; harbour master and pub enquiries | Anyone                                                                                | None then. On Day 222 the proper look pulls everything on Brad and finds nothing, because the file does not carry his name. On Day 333 the name arrested 400 miles away is the name on this file, and the skipper is the man who can say where the deckhand used to drink |
| 10b | The deckhand is dead, and how                                                                                                     | Brad                                                                                             | Day -1100                                 | His act                                                | Nobody                                                                                | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |



| #   | Fact                                                          | Holder                                                                  | From                | Route                             | Could tell                                         | Recipient's earliest action                                                      |
|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 10c | The deckhand drank at Brad Collins's flat                     | The skipper (a mate's; he learns whose only when Brad's name is on air) | Day -1200           | The deckhand said so              | Anyone                                             | The skipper writes to Ally on Day 311. To Del, never aired                       |
| 10d | No document anywhere carries Brad's face under the other name | Brad                                                                    | Day -900            | His design                        | Nobody                                             | An activity check on the name, if ever run, returns nothing since Day -1090      |
| 11  | A panel in an unknown hand was hidden in Violet's roof space  | Violet; four people she showed it to                                    | Day -75; -70 to -40 | The leak; she carried it round    | Anyone                                             | The four she showed: none, it is a panel                                         |
| 12  | Violet is asking round town whose hand                        | Café owner, cinema owner, two signwriters; Brad from the café           | Day -70 to -40      | Direct                            | Anyone                                             | Brad: accelerate                                                                 |
| 13  | The ladder foot was undone, not sheared                       | Violet                                                                  | Day -45             | Her own inspection                | Police, if she chose                               | Police: examine the ladder, no offence proven, no suspect named, note and advise |
| 14  | Violet fell from a ladder and was treated                     | Ruby (clinical record), Violet, the four                                | Day -45             | Surgery                           | Ruby: nobody outside care                          | None                                                                             |
| 15  | Four keys cut to one new padlock                              | Locksmith                                                               | Day -20             | His book                          | Anyone asking                                      | None                                                                             |
| 16  | Four sealed envelopes lodged to be posted after her funeral   | Solicitor                                                               | Day -18             | Instruction                       | Nobody: client confidence, contents unknown to him | None; on death, post them                                                        |
| 17  | Violet believes one of the four is planning to kill her       | Violet only                                                             | Day -45 to 0        | Her inference from rows 11 and 13 | Police                                             | See Part C, Violet                                                               |

## B2. Facts created on Day 0 and by the death

| #  | Fact                                                  | Holder                                                 | From  | Route       | Could tell                    | Recipient's earliest action                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-------|-------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 18 | Brad walked to and from Mariner's Row on Monday night | Brad; No. 14 saw a man's back, carrying something flat | Day 0 | Direct      | No. 14: anyone                | Told at the Day 1 door-knock. Noted: unidentified male in the lane, approx 22:30. No description beyond build and a coat. Nothing to test it against; the four are asked on Day 2 whether any of them called Monday night and all say no. On Day 222 it is re-read against Liam, who held a key. A listener on Day 297 notes the build No. 14 gave is wrong for Liam |
| 19 | Brad's phone was at his flat all evening              | Carrier (cell-site)                                    | Day 0 | Records, R8 | Police on lawful request only | None without a suspect                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

| #  | Fact                                                                | Holder                                         | From        | Route                                  | Could tell           | Recipient's earliest action                                                                                            |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-------------|----------------------------------------|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 20 | Her debt book is gone                                               | Brad; Margo notices its absence Day 8          | Day 0 / 8   | Margo helped the sister with paperwork | Margo: the sister    | Sister: shrug; nobody else knew it existed. The book is Brad's exemplar for her cursive on Day 17 and is ash by Day 18 |
| 21 | Violet died of a head injury at the foot of her stairs, unwitnessed | HCPD, Cortez, coroner, the four, the sister    | Day 1 to 3  | Scene, PM, R5                          | Public in outline    | Coroner: accident (Ruling 1)                                                                                           |
| 22 | A fall six weeks earlier is on her GP record                        | Ruby, the PM (via GP)                          | Day -45 / 3 | Record                                 | Supports the finding | None                                                                                                                   |
| 23 | Liam found her and holds a key to the house                         | HCPD file                                      | Day 1       | Sudden-death report                    | Police               | None; noted                                                                                                            |
| 24 | The tin exists and went to the sister                               | The four, the sister, HCPD (noted as property) | Day 2 to 5  | Liam's honesty                         | Anyone               | None                                                                                                                   |

### B3. The letters and the cage

| #  | Fact                                                                                                                                                                                | Holder                                                                              | From       | Route       | Could tell                                    | Recipient's earliest action                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|-------------|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 25 | Each of the four holds a letter in her hand: I think, one of you, not the police, the cage                                                                                          | The four                                                                            | Day 14     | Post        | Each: anyone. The letter asks them not to     | Del, if handed it: statement; under R22 the document is examined before anything is done with it (weeks; consistent); no offence, no named suspect, a closed accident; the coroner's officer is asked whether it changes anything: it does not (R19). The letter comes back to its owner with a police stamp saying it is hers |
| 26 | Which cage, and that it holds a thing                                                                                                                                               | The four                                                                            | Day 14     | The letter  | Anyone                                        | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 27 | Brad went to the cage on the Wednesday and the Friday                                                                                                                               | Brad; the Bay 3 fishmonger (Wed); the loading-bay camera (both, R7 thirty-one days) | Day 16, 18 | Sight; tape | Fishmonger: anyone. Nobody asks until Day 290 | Camera expires Day 47 and 49 unflagged: no case exists to flag it                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 28 | What the genuine cage letter said: the ladder foot, the panel, the mark, "not Brad's hand, I taught him", and an instruction to pool everything odd each of you knows of the others | Brad only                                                                           | Day 16     | He read it  | Nobody                                        | It is ash                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 29 | The panel is in Brad's possession                                                                                                                                                   | Brad                                                                                | Day 16     | Taken       | Nobody                                        | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

| #  | Fact                                                                                                                              | Holder                       | From   | Route               | Could tell                                    | Recipient's earliest action                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|--------|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 30 | The cage letter (forged) says I know; the tin is Liam's; the yard; the ladder told to Liam; the board; and never mentions a panel | The four, then Ruby's drawer | Day 19 | The cage            | Anyone; the letter itself says not the police | Del, if handed it on any day from 19: as row 25, examination routine under R22: consistent                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 31 | The name board is Violet's, hung in her hall for eight years, and none of the four had been in the house since before Day -19     | The four                     | Day 19 | Recognition         | Anyone                                        | None: she took it down and put it there, they assume, and nobody can say when the hook emptied (row 5b)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 32 | Liam's third is confirmed in the room                                                                                             | The four                     | Day 27 | Liam                | Anyone                                        | Del: a lawful shareholding                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 33 | The letter has the money wrong                                                                                                    | Margo only                   | Day 44 | Her own file, row 2 | Del, the room, Tessa                          | Del: statement recorded, both documents preserved, R22 examination (consistent), the contradiction referred to the coroner's officer, who finds that a dispute about where a dead woman's cash came from is not evidence of an act (R19). The allegation does not fail; it stays open and unresolved on a closed file, all four are interviewed about the cage, and the room learns she called the letter a fake |
| 34 | Margo has stopped arguing with Brad                                                                                               | Brad                         | Day 47 | Observation         | Nobody                                        | Go                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

## B4. The vanish

| #  | Fact                                                                                                | Holder                                                     | From   | Route       | Could tell        | Recipient's earliest action                    |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|--------|-------------|-------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 35 | Brad's van, phone, message and watch are at Kestrel Head                                            | HCPD (Del), the three, the dog walker                      | Day 54 | Scene       | Public in outline | Del: MP, search, sample, interviews (Ruling 2) |
| 36 | His flat holds his passport, cards, tools, laptop; his accounts are thin and untouched after Day 53 | HCPD                                                       | Day 54 | Search      | Police            | Consistent with the water                      |
| 37 | A reference sample and prints exist for Brad Collins                                                | HCPD                                                       | Day 55 | MP practice | Police            | Retained (Ruling 2)                            |
| 38 | He walked the ridge path and took the 05:47                                                         | The halt's platform camera (R7, expires Day 85); the clerk | Day 54 | Sight; tape | Anyone, if asked  | Nobody asks: the MP is presumed in the sea     |
| 39 | A bag was placed at the ridge wall on Day 46                                                        | Brad                                                       | Day 46 | His act     | Nobody            | None; the wall is empty by Day 54              |

| #  | Fact                                                           | Holder                    | From          | Route         | Could tell                                     | Recipient's earliest action                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|---------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 40 | The three were meeting weekly over letters from the dead woman | The three                 | Day 19 onward | Their own act | Del at interview Day 55                        | If told: Del reads the vanish as a grieving man. If shown the letters: Del reads the vanish as possible guilt, notes it on the closed file, cannot charge a presumed-dead man, cannot reopen a coroner's finding on a text message (Ruling 1). Either way, nothing moves |
| 41 | Brad's things are in boxes at Ruby's                           | Ruby, the landlord        | Day 110       | Clearance     | Anyone                                         | None; there is nothing in them                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 42 | "The thing in the cupboard is wrong. It can't mean that."      | Tessa (screenshot); Margo | Day 70        | The app       | Tessa: anyone; she does not know what cupboard | None until asked                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

## B5. The stranger and the second death

| #  | Fact                                                            | Holder                                                                                 | From           | Route                               | Could tell                                      | Recipient's earliest action                                                                                                                   |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 43 | A stranger on the green app knows things about Brad's death     | Margo; Brad                                                                            | Day 180        | The app                             | Margo: Tessa, Del, Ruby, Liam. She tells nobody | If she told Del: a number that leads nowhere on a self-deleting app; nothing to pull; note. If she told Tessa: Tessa would tell her not to go |
| 44 | The meeting: Friday, the point, eleven                          | Margo, Brad                                                                            | Day 212        | The app                             | As 43                                           | As 43                                                                                                                                         |
| 45 | Brad was absent from the lodgings Friday to Saturday            | The landlady                                                                           | Day 213        | Told a job                          | Anyone                                          | None until Day 327                                                                                                                            |
| 46 | Brad rode the trains south and north on cash                    | Guards, the halt clerk, platform camera (R7, expires Day 246), a woman on the platform | Day 214, 215   | Sight                               | Anyone if asked                                 | Nobody asks: the death is an apparent suicide (Rulings 5, 7)                                                                                  |
| 47 | Brad's prepaid pinged the Kestrel Head cell at 22:50 on Day 214 | Carrier                                                                                | Day 214        | Records, R8                         | Police on a tower request                       | A tower dump is not ordered for an apparent suicide (Ruling 5)                                                                                |
| 48 | Margo's car, ten minutes early, and her body three days later   | HCPD, the dog walker, her office, Tessa                                                | Day 215, 218   | Scene                               | Public                                          | Del: search; Ruling 6 link; Ruling 7 camera; PM                                                                                               |
| 49 | Margo had a partner nobody knew                                 | Tessa, HCPD                                                                            | Day 215        | Tessa rang                          | Police                                          | Statement; last movements                                                                                                                     |
| 50 | Margo's phone is not recovered                                  | HCPD                                                                                   | Day 218        | Search                              | Police                                          | Carrier records (row 47's reach is the ruling)                                                                                                |
| 51 | Two survivors, five letters, three deaths                       | HCPD                                                                                   | Day 219 to 222 | Del's own initiative and their fear | Police                                          | The proper look: Days 222 to 262                                                                                                              |

| #  | Fact                                                 | Holder          | From    | Route        | Could tell                     | Recipient's earliest action                          |
|----|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|---------|--------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 52 | The cage letter is consistent with her known samples | HCPD            | Day 250 | Examination  | Police; the survivors are told | Nothing to act on                                    |
| 53 | The letters were lodged on Day -18                   | Solicitor, HCPD | Day 235 | Confirmation | Police                         | Her fear predates her death; it does not name an act |

## B6. What Ally can reach, and from whom

| #  | Fact                                               | Ally's source                             | Day        | Lawful                                                                           | Route into the episode                          |
|----|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| 54 | Everything public                                  | Gazette front page                        | 266        | Yes                                                                              | Ep 1                                            |
| 55 | The letters, the room, the boxes, Brad's habits    | Ruby, on record                           | 270 onward | Yes: Ruby owns her letter and holds the cage letter after its return from police | Ep 2                                            |
| 56 | The debts being called in; the panel carried round | Café owner, cinema owner, two signwriters | 280 to 304 | Yes                                                                              | Ep 3, 6, 9                                      |
| 57 | Brad at the cage on the Wednesday                  | Bay 3 fishmonger, Tip Line                | 290        | Yes, caller consents                                                             | To Del. Not aired                               |
| 58 | Liam's side                                        | Liam                                      | 288        | Yes                                                                              | Ep 4                                            |
| 59 | The screenshot                                     | Tessa                                     | 300        | Yes: Tessa owns it                                                               | Ep 6, anonymised, with consent                  |
| 60 | The 05:47 and the boots                            | The platform woman                        | 318        | Yes                                                                              | To Del. Ally asks on air for others             |
| 61 | A persistent listener in one town 400 miles away   | Her own download map                      | 283 onward | Yes, her own data                                                                | To Del on Day 326 as corroboration. Never aired |
| 62 | The solicitor's covering slip and postmark         | Ruby's envelope                           | 276        | Yes                                                                              | Ep 7                                            |
| 63 | The lodger, the wall, the gap                      | The landlady, private message             | 326        | Yes                                                                              | To Del at 07:00. Never aired                    |
| 64 | Anything in the police file                        | Del                                       |            | No, and she never gets it. Del says looked, nothing                              | Ally's sourcing never depends on the file       |

## B7. Residue: what Brad's swap, vanish, contact and return leave behind

| #  | Residue                                                                  | Where it sits                                                                                                    | Who could find it                                                                                                          | When it dies                    |
|----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| R1 | Two dawn visits to Cage 4                                                | Loading-bay camera; Bay 3 fishmonger's memory                                                                    | Anyone who asks the market; nobody does until Ally                                                                         | Tape Day 47/49. Memory does not |
| R2 | Her pen and paper used, drafts burned, the debt book burned              | Nothing survives; the pen is back in the unit and goes to the sister                                             | Nobody                                                                                                                     | Day 17                          |
| R3 | A hand better than his public one, and years of private practice of hers | Only in the cage letter, which passes as hers; the practice sheets were burned each Tuesday night from Day -1800 | An examiner told to compare it against Brad's public work would find no match, because he never wrote in that hand as Brad | Never tested that way           |

| #   | Residue                                                                            | Where it sits                                                                                                                                       | Who could find it                                                                                                                                          | When it dies                          |
|-----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| R3a | Nobody in the room ever saw Brad write cursive                                     | Their memories                                                                                                                                      | A listener who asks: what did his handwriting look like? Ruby cannot answer; Ally airs that on Day 311                                                     | Never                                 |
| R4  | The bag at the ridge wall                                                          | Dry-stone wall, eight days                                                                                                                          | A walker between Day 46 and 53                                                                                                                             | Day 53                                |
| R5  | The walk and the 05:47 on Day 54                                                   | Platform camera; the clerk                                                                                                                          | Anyone asking the halt                                                                                                                                     | Tape Day 85; the clerk's memory fades |
| R6  | The identity: a missing man's genuine name, with Brad's face on no document        | The low-risk MP file in Del's own precinct, last address the boat; the deckhand's genuine passport and birth certificate in a drawer 400 miles away | The other force on Day 333 runs the arrested name and hits the file (Ruling 8). Nothing links the file to Brad before that day                             | Never                                 |
| R6a | The skipper who reported him                                                       | His memory: the deckhand drank at a mate's, and the mate was Brad Collins                                                                           | Ally's listeners; he writes in on Day 311. To Del, never aired                                                                                             | Memory                                |
| R6b | The deckhand's dry bag at Brad's flat, three years                                 | Gone with the papers by Day -900; the flat search on Day 54 finds nothing of him                                                                    | Nobody                                                                                                                                                     | Day -900                              |
| R7  | Quarterly cash rent for over a year before he vanished                             | The landlady's rent book                                                                                                                            | Anyone who asks her, after Day 327                                                                                                                         | Never                                 |
| R8  | The prepaid's cell hits at Kestrel Head, Day 214                                   | Carrier                                                                                                                                             | A tower request (Ruling 5)                                                                                                                                 | R8: seven years                       |
| R9  | The trains, Days 213 to 215                                                        | Guards, clerk, platform camera; the woman on the platform                                                                                           | Anyone asking; the woman writes to Ally on Day 318                                                                                                         | Tape Day 246                          |
| R10 | Wet boots and a cash single at 05:40                                               | The clerk, the woman                                                                                                                                | As R9                                                                                                                                                      | Memory                                |
| R11 | Absence from the lodgings, Day 213 to 215, told as a job                           | The landlady                                                                                                                                        | After Day 327                                                                                                                                              | Never                                 |
| R12 | Ash in a workshop stove, Day 325                                                   | The stove                                                                                                                                           | The other force, Day 333                                                                                                                                   | Days                                  |
| R13 | A persistent download in one town from Day 283                                     | Ally's analytics                                                                                                                                    | Ally                                                                                                                                                       | Never                                 |
| R14 | The debt book                                                                      | Burned with the drafts, Day 17                                                                                                                      | Nobody                                                                                                                                                     | Day 17                                |
| R15 | A man's back in the lane at 22:30, Day 0, carrying something flat                  | No. 14; the sudden-death file (unidentified male, lane)                                                                                             | The Day 222 review re-reads it against Liam; a listener on Day 297 says the build is wrong for Liam and asks what the flat thing was                       | Memory; the file note is permanent    |
| R16 | An empty hook and a pale rectangle on the hall wall in the Day 1 scene photographs | The sudden-death file (R5: the sister may obtain the evidence tendered)                                                                             | Nobody reads a scene photograph for a missing board; the sister, who never knew the board, has the file's findings and not its photographs unless she asks | Never                                 |

## C. THE SWEEP (STEP 1b, WITH THE RECIPIENT COLUMN)

Authored order ignored. For each person, from the first day they can know anything: what they can lawfully know · the earliest competent action · the recipient · the recipient's earliest response · every duty the combined facts trigger · the earliest consequential outcome. A suppression is named in the last column and must be world-supplied. The planned turns it is measured against: the swap (Day 18), the reading landing on Liam (Day 89), Brad's vanish (Day 53), Margo's death (Day 214), the survivors at the station (Day 219), Ally (Day 269), the identification (Day 333).

**Rule applied throughout:** an open route that reaches an authority and produces nothing is not a suppression. It is computed, the recipient is named, and the outcome is written down.

## C1. Violet (Day -120 to Day 0)

| Week      | What she can know                                                          | Earliest competent action        | Recipient                 | Recipient's earliest response                                                                                 | Duties triggered                  | Outcome                                                                      | Named cost                                                                |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| -11 to -7 | Someone hid a panel in her roof; someone close has a hand she cannot place | Ask round town                   | Signwriters, café, cinema | Nobody knows the hand                                                                                         | None                              | Brad hears                                                                   | She pays with the acceleration (Day -40)                                  |
| -7        | The ladder foot was undone                                                 | Report to police with the ladder | Del (Harbor Ward)         | Examine the ladder; a bolt undone is not an offence proven; no suspect named; log, advise, offer nothing more | None: no offence, no named person | A record that she was frightened, and the person who did it learns she knows | Her refusal is competent and her stated reason is correct. Cost: her life |
| -3        | The above, combined                                                        | Tell one of the four             | Any of the four           | Three would go to the police with her; one would move                                                         | None                              | 25 per cent chance of telling the killer                                     | Her design (four keys) is her answer to exactly this. Paid                |
| -3        | The above                                                                  | Tell her solicitor why           | Solicitor                 | Advise police; cannot compel                                                                                  | None on sealed envelopes          | As row -7                                                                    | She jokes instead. Consistent with the five                               |

**Verdict:** PASS. Every route Violet had ends at the same desk with the same result and the killer informed. She chose the design the premise rests on. The sweep does not require her to be right; it requires her refusal to be hers, and it is.

## C2. Brad (coherence with what he wants, not risk minimisation)

| Week | Position                                  | Action taken           | Coherent because                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Cheaper alternative rejected, and why                                                  |
|------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| -157 | He needs a name nobody will ever look for | Kill the lodger for it | A bought name has a seller; a dead infant's record has a register; a man with no one, reported by a skipper and closed as drifted, is the only name with no file that watches it. The exit came first, and this is what first means | Take the papers and let the man live; a living man reclaims a name the day he needs it |



| Week     | Position                                 | Action taken                                                           | Coherent because                                                                                                                                                                | Cheaper alternative rejected, and why                                                                                 |
|----------|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| -16      | The debt is called in; the exit is built | Decide she dies                                                        | Leaving as Brad Collins with a debt to a woman who forgets nobody lights up the cash economy Margo audits; dying as Brad Collins needs a grief; hers gives him both             | Pay her: the cash is the exit. Move: a man who moved is a man who can be found                                        |
| -7       | The ladder                               | A fall that reads as a fall                                            | Falls are his method; a survivor who slipped is survivable                                                                                                                      | A weapon leaves a wound the PM reads                                                                                  |
| -6       | She is carrying the panel round          | Wait for the debt conversation to give him a reason to be in her house | A visit about money is an ordinary visit                                                                                                                                        | Retrieve the panel first: she has hidden it and he cannot search her without showing his hand                         |
| 1        | The stairs                               | One push, twenty minutes, the book, the lane                           | One impact, no second wound; the phone at home; on foot                                                                                                                         | Finish her if she breathed: a second injury is the end of accident                                                    |
| 3        | The key letter                           | Read the cage on the Wednesday, not the Saturday                       | The cage letter says what she reasoned and the panel is there; both must go before four people read them                                                                        | Do nothing: the four pool what they know and he is the only one with weekends away, cash and a question about the van |
| 3        | The cage letter read                     | Swap, do not empty                                                     | Empty tells four people someone came early; a letter in her hand that says I know hands them weeks of work pointing elsewhere                                                   | Destroy the panel: it is the best thing he has made and she wrote that he could not have made it                      |
| 3 to 7   | The room                                 | Defend Liam on she might have been wrong                               | An innocent surface, and the reading returns harder each time                                                                                                                   | Accuse Liam: legible forwards, and Liam reads him like an invoice                                                     |
| 7        | Margo has gone quiet                     | Go now, by the plan ready since Day 30                                 | A second death in the group is a case; a grieving friend at Kestrel Head is not                                                                                                 | Kill Margo now: see previous cell                                                                                     |
| 8 to 25  | Missing, presumed                        | Nothing. Listen.                                                       | The least-cost move is stillness                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                       |
| 26 to 30 | Margo has not spoken in five months      | Contact her from a prepaid, on Violet's information                    | She is the one person who can think alive; he needs to know whether she has been turned, and he wants to be the one who turns her (the want the least-cost test does not score) | Stillness: she may speak any week and he will not know until it is too late                                           |
| 31       | She will not turn                        | The meeting at the point                                               | A woman who blamed herself for one man at that cliff dies at that cliff and everyone has the reason ready; and she must hand him the phone                                      | Leave her: the one person who thinks alive is now certain there is a stranger who knows too much                      |
| 39 to 47 | Ally is airing it                        | Stay. Listen.                                                          | Leaving costs the built life and would confirm to someone nearby that they had seen something                                                                                   |                                                                                                                       |
| 47       | The panel described                      | Burn it that night; watch the house                                    | Someone near him may have seen it; he cannot know who; the object must not exist                                                                                                | Run: as above                                                                                                         |
| 47       | The landlady changes                     | Notice her, as Margo                                                   | Too late: she wrote the night she looked                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                       |

**Verdict:** every action is coherent from inside and the two that look insane from outside (the contact, the return) are the compulsion the three real cases show, and the residue rows in B7 price them.

### C3. Liam

| Week     | What he can lawfully know                               | Earliest competent action                                                            | Recipient                          | Recipient's earliest response                                                                                                                                               | Duties                      | Outcome                                                                                                   | Named cost / lock                                                                                      |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1        | He found her; the tin                                   | Hand the tin to the sister                                                           | Sister                             | Takes it                                                                                                                                                                    | None                        | Done Day 5                                                                                                | None                                                                                                   |
| 3        | The key letter                                          | Take it to Del                                                                       | Del                                | Row 25: read, note, no offence, ask the coroner's officer, nothing changes                                                                                                  | None                        | Nothing; the other three learn he went                                                                    | Violet's reasons still live; he holds nothing but a maybe                                              |
| 4        | The cage letter names his third and says the tin is his | As above, with a letter in her hand that names his secret and calls the money his    | Del                                | Statement; the yard's affairs are lawful; the letter is not an allegation of an act by him; note                                                                            | None                        | Liam is the man who brought police a letter accusing himself; the third is on a police file; nothing else | <b>Self-interest lock, tested:</b> holds, because the only document he owns points at him              |
| 6        | Brad defends him, loses                                 | As above                                                                             |                                    |                                                                                                                                                                             |                             |                                                                                                           | Holds                                                                                                  |
| 8        | Brad is missing                                         | Tell Del at interview: we were working her letters and they had begun to point at me | Del                                | Row 40: reads the vanish as guilt or grief; either way no charge, no reopening; Liam is now the man the letters pointed at, on the file, beside a friend who killed himself | None                        | Nothing moves; the file now contains him                                                                  | Holds, and harder: a dead friend's message plus a letter pointing at him is worse for him than silence |
| 13       | It lands on him                                         | I am frightened of Ruby                                                              | Del                                | What has she done? Nothing. Note                                                                                                                                            | None                        | Nothing                                                                                                   | Holds: fear of the letter still exceeds fear of Ruby                                                   |
| 14 to 30 | Silence, estrangement                                   | As above                                                                             |                                    |                                                                                                                                                                             |                             |                                                                                                           | Holds; nothing has changed                                                                             |
| 31       | Margo is dead at the same cliff                         | Go in, now                                                                           | Del (who is already coming to him) | The proper look                                                                                                                                                             | Police duty on three deaths | Days 222 to 262                                                                                           | <b>The break point, exactly where finding 2 put it:</b> fear of a person exceeds fear of the letter    |

**Verdict:** PASS. The lock is renewed at every change of facts and breaks on the change the premise breaks it on. Note for the attack: at Week 8 Liam's route is open and computed, and it makes his position worse, which is why he does not take it.

## C4. Ruby (with the professional duty run separately)

| Week | What she can lawfully know                                   | Earliest competent action                                       | Recipient            | Recipient's earliest response                                                                                                                                                            | Duties                                                                                                                                                    | Outcome                                                                                                                                                           | Named cost / lock                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| -7   | Violet fell from a ladder                                    | Treat, record                                                   | Record               |                                                                                                                                                                                          | Clinical: done                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 1    | Violet is dead; the record shows a prior fall                | Nothing to act on                                               |                      |                                                                                                                                                                                          | Reading the record without a clinical reason is a breach; she does it                                                                                     | Nothing                                                                                                                                                           | Cost: a breach she never mentions                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 3    | The key letter                                               | Take it to Del                                                  | Del                  | Row 25                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Professional duty tested:</b> a written fear by a dead person names no living person at risk; safeguarding duties attach to the living; no duty arises | Nothing; Violet's instruction broken for nothing                                                                                                                  | Lock: her reading is she was frightened, then she fell, and she read every face in that kitchen and saw no lie                                                                                          |
| 4    | Liam's third is true, so the letter is right about something | <b>Duty renews on the new fact.</b> Go to Del with both letters | Del                  | Statement; <b>R22: both letters examined before anything else, weeks, consistent;</b> a lawful secret; the letter alleges no act; the coroner's officer: no new evidence of an act (R19) | None: still no living person at risk                                                                                                                      | Nothing, Liam learns she went, and the letter returns to the room with a police stamp saying it is Violet's, which makes the reading harder to resist, not easier | <b>Open route, computed, does not deliver.</b> She does not take it because it costs her the room and gains nothing, which is a reason the world supplies. If she did, the room would be worse for Liam |
| 6    | The tin claim; Liam denies                                   | As above                                                        |                      |                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                   | Holds                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 8    | Brad missing with a message                                  | Tell Del about the letters                                      | Del                  | Row 40                                                                                                                                                                                   | None: Brad is presumed dead, nobody alive is named at risk                                                                                                | Nothing moves                                                                                                                                                     | She reads the message as grief because she loves him; and Violet's reasons still live because the letter's suspects are still alive                                                                     |
| 13   | It lands on Liam                                             | I am frightened of him                                          | Del                  | What has he done? Nothing. Note                                                                                                                                                          | None                                                                                                                                                      | Nothing                                                                                                                                                           | Holds                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 16   | The boxes                                                    | Nothing in them                                                 |                      |                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 31   | Margo dead                                                   | Go in                                                           | Del (already coming) | The proper look                                                                                                                                                                          | Police duty                                                                                                                                               | Days 222 to 262                                                                                                                                                   | Break point: fear of a person                                                                                                                                                                           |

| Week | What she can lawfully know | Earliest competent action | Recipient | Recipient's earliest response | Duties | Outcome | Named cost / lock    |
|------|----------------------------|---------------------------|-----------|-------------------------------|--------|---------|----------------------|
| 38   | No further action          | Talk to the Gazette       | Gazette   | Front page                    |        | Ally    | Her fear made public |

**Verdict:** PASS, with the thin lock named: from Day 27 Ruby has an open route to Del, every week, that produces a note on a closed file and a friend who knows she broke the dead woman's instruction. The spine does not silence her; it computes what she would get and it is nothing.

## C5. Margo

| Week | What she can lawfully know                 | Earliest competent action | Recipient | Recipient's earliest response | Duties                                                                                                                                            | Outcome | Named cost / lock |
|------|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------|-----------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|-------------------|
| -17  | Violet is calling in debts; Brad owes most | Nothing: lawful           |           |                               | Accountant's confidence to Violet                                                                                                                 |         |                   |
| 2    | The debt book is gone                      | Tell the sister           | Sister    | Shrug                         | None                                                                                                                                              | Nothing |                   |
| 3    | The key letter                             | Take it to Del            | Del       | Row 25                        | <b>Professional duty tested:</b> she is an accountant, not a regulated reporter of suspected homicide; nothing in the letter is a financial crime | Nothing | Holds as Ruby's   |
| 4    | Liam's third (new to her)                  | As above                  |           |                               |                                                                                                                                                   |         | Holds             |

| Week     | What she can lawfully know     | Earliest competent action                                  | Recipient                              | Recipient's earliest response                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Duties | Outcome                                                                                                                                                                              | Named cost / lock                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|----------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6 to 7   | The letter has the money wrong | (a) Say so in the room.<br>(b) Take it to Del as a forgery | (a) The room. (b) Del                  | (a) The room asks how she knows; she must say Violet told her a thing she promised not to repeat, in front of the person who forged it.<br>(b) Forgery allegation on a closed accident: statement, documents preserved, R22 examination (consistent), contradiction referred to the coroner's officer and found not to be evidence of an act (R19); the allegation stays open and unresolved; all four are interviewed about who could have reached the cage before Saturday; she is the friend who called the dead woman's letter a fake | None   | (a) Brad knows tonight. (b) Brad is interviewed within the week, learns from the question what she has said, and the letter carries a police stamp saying it is consistent with hers | <b>The thinnest lock in the spine, six days, named:</b> she wants certainty before accusing a friend, she runs the sums three nights, and the sums point at the man she has never liked, which is the reason she distrusts them.<br>Paid: Day 53 |
| 8        | Brad is gone                   | Tell Del: I think he forged it                             | Del                                    | Forgery allegation against a presumed-dead man on a closed case: statement, examination (consistent), the cage's access asked about, nothing to charge and nobody to charge                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | None   | Nothing, and she has said in public what she cannot live with                                                                                                                        | Guilt lock: she chooses she was wrong about him. Available to her because her certainty rests on what Violet told her, and Violet lied about cigarettes with total confidence                                                                    |
| 10       | Guilt                          | Tell Tessa                                                 | Tessa                                  | Tessa: what cupboard? Margo does not explain                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | None   | A screenshot                                                                                                                                                                         | Eleven years of compartments                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 13       | It lands on Liam               | Say the letter is wrong                                    | The room                               | As Week 6 (a), with a dead man as the only alternative                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | None   |                                                                                                                                                                                      | Holds: the alternative is that she killed Brad                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 26 to 30 | A stranger who knows           | Tell Del; tell Tessa                                       | Del: nothing to pull. Tessa: do not go | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |        | Holds: the stranger is the only person offering her the reading she can live in                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 31       | The meeting                    | Do not go                                                  |                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |        |                                                                                                                                                                                      | She goes ten minutes early                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

**Verdict:** PASS. The six-day lock is the one the step-3 attack should hit first.

## C6. Tessa

| Week | What she can lawfully know                                        | Earliest competent action  | Recipient       | Recipient's earliest response                                                                      | Duties | Outcome                                                                                  |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 10   | A line about a cupboard                                           | Ask                        | Margo           | Does not explain                                                                                   | None   | Screenshot kept                                                                          |
| 31   | Margo has not answered since Friday and does not arrive on Sunday | Ring the police            | Havenbay police | Statement; last movements; she is on the file by 14:00 on Day 216, the day after the car was found | None   | The partner nobody knew is found by the review inside 36 hours, because she came forward |
| 35   | Re-interviewed                                                    | Give the line              | Detective       | Read as doubt about the reading; on file                                                           | None   | Nothing                                                                                  |
| 43   | Ally asks                                                         | Write, with the screenshot | Ally            | On air, anonymised                                                                                 |        | Ep 6                                                                                     |

**Verdict:** PASS. Tessa acts on the first day every time. What she holds does not carry a who.

## C7. Del and HCPD

| Day | The file on the desk                                                     | Earliest competent action                                                                                        | Duties triggered                  | Outcome                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Why it stops there                                                                                                       |
|-----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1   | Unwitnessed sudden death, head injury, stairs, secure house              | Scene, PM, coroner, door-knock (movements and visitors)                                                          | Sudden death procedure            | Accident (Ruling 1). No. 14's man in the lane is noted as unidentified; the four are asked on Day 2 whether any of them called and all say no                                                                | Nothing at the scene says otherwise; the PM cannot; an unidentified man in a back lane with no description is not an act |
| 54  | MP at a known site, message, watch, seven weeks after his friend's death | Search, sample, flat, interviews                                                                                 | MP procedure (Ruling 2)           | Missing, presumed                                                                                                                                                                                            | Nobody mentions letters; if they had, row 40                                                                             |
| 215 | A second car from the same four at the same site                         | Link the files (Ruling 6); search; Tessa's statement                                                             | MP, then sudden death             | Suicide pending PM                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                          |
| 218 | Body, PM, phone absent                                                   | Last movements (Ruling 5); camera (Ruling 7); interview the surviving friends                                    | Sudden-death procedure; a cluster | Del reaches Liam and Ruby on Day 219 before they reach her                                                                                                                                                   | Competent and on time                                                                                                    |
| 222 | Five letters, three deaths, two accusations                              | Examination (Ruling 4); solicitor; coroner's officer; app provider; carrier; everything held on each of the four | All run, Days 222 to 262          | Consistent; lodged Day -18; no new evidence of an act; no content; no recoverable contact; nothing on Brad beyond his own MP file; the lane sighting re-read against Liam, who held a key, and going nowhere | Nothing where they are looking, because nothing is there                                                                 |

| Day | The file on the desk               | Earliest competent action                                                                                                                                                            | Duties triggered                                                                                | Outcome                                                                   | Why it stops there                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 226 | The letters' stated origin: Cage 4 | The detective visits the cage (empty since Day 82, padlock cut by the sister), confirms the corridor is open in market hours with no custodian, asks the market manager about access | Proper review of a material document includes where it was found (finding 5, accepted this far) | Access: anyone with a key, any morning. The camera expired on Day 47 (R7) | <b>Ruled, R27 (Stephen, 2026-08-30):</b> the review inspects the place and its access; a canvass of bystanders about who came before the finders needs an allegation or a hypothesis of tampering. Nobody alive holds one: authorship is examined and consistent, and both survivors dispute the reading, not the origin. Ally asks it on Day 290 because Tessa's line gave her the hypothesis. Finding 5 closed |
| 327 | A landlady's message via Ally      | Other force, prints, arrest                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                 | Day 333                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

**Verdict:** PASS. Nothing is withheld from Del and she initiates the survivor interviews herself. What the file cannot do is name a living man or reopen a finding without evidence of an act.

## C8. Everyone else

| Person                        | Knows                                                         | Earliest action           | Recipient            | Response                                                                                    | Why nothing follows                                                                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The skipper                   | His deckhand missed a sailing, Day -1090; drank "at a mate's" | Report him missing        | Harbor Ward          | Harbour master, the pub (not there that night), the boat; low risk; closed as drifted (R16) | An itinerant adult with no one. The mate is never named because the skipper never knew the name until it was on air. He writes to Ally on Day 311; to Del, never aired |
| The constable, Day -1090      | A man living aboard, last seen going ashore                   | Record, canvass, classify | The file             | Low risk                                                                                    | Correct on what was in front of him; no one to place him with Brad. The pub is removed as a holder: the drinking was at the flat                                       |
| Solicitor                     | Four sealed envelopes, Day -18                                | Post after funeral        | The four             |                                                                                             | Contents unknown to him; no duty                                                                                                                                       |
| Sister                        | Tin, house, unit, an empty cage at Day 82                     | None                      |                      |                                                                                             | An empty cage is an empty cage                                                                                                                                         |
| Locksmith                     | Four keys, Day -20                                            | None                      |                      |                                                                                             | Nobody asks until Ally                                                                                                                                                 |
| No. 14                        | A man's back, Day 0                                           | None                      | Police, if asked     | Not asked                                                                                   | The question on Day 1 was when she was last seen                                                                                                                       |
| Bay 3 fishmonger              | Brad at the cage, Day 16                                      | None until asked          | Tip Line, Day 290    | To Del                                                                                      | A friend at a dead friend's cage is not a thing to report                                                                                                              |
| Pub landlord                  | Paid Brad cash for a year                                     | None                      |                      |                                                                                             | Lawful                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Café, cinema, two signwriters | A gold panel, whose hand                                      | None                      | Ally, Day 283 onward |                                                                                             | A panel                                                                                                                                                                |

| Person                             | Knows                                                                          | Earliest action                                                                                                                                    | Recipient                            | Response | Why nothing follows                                               |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Landlord (flat)                    | Rent stopped                                                                   | Clear, boxes to Ruby                                                                                                                               |                                      |          |                                                                   |
| The halt clerk, the platform woman | Wet boots, cash, Day 215                                                       | None until asked                                                                                                                                   | Ally, Day 318                        | To Del   | A man with wet boots on a morning train                           |
| The landlady                       | A lodger under the other name; his absences; the panel on his wall; his habits | Write to Ally the night the panel is gone (Day 326). The other route, her local police, would put a constable on her doorstep the day he came home | Ally, then Del, then the other force | Day 333  | Her window is hours and she uses them                             |
| Ally                               | Everything in B6                                                               | Del first, every time                                                                                                                              | Del                                  |          | Airing a name would tell him which town; she never has one to air |

## C9. Causal order check (pipeline rule 5)

| Claimed cause                 | Date       | Claimed effect                         | Date           | Holds                                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------|------------|----------------------------------------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The exit needs a name         | -1100      | The lodger dies; the papers            | -1100          | Yes: the exit precedes the debt by a thousand days                                                                       |
| The debt called in            | -110       | Decision                               | -110           | Yes                                                                                                                      |
| The panel shown round         | -70 to -40 | Brad hears; acceleration               | -40; 0         | Yes                                                                                                                      |
| The ladder                    | -45        | Violet's belief, the cage, the letters | -20 to -18     | Yes                                                                                                                      |
| The key letter names the cage | 14         | Brad's first visit                     | 16             | Yes                                                                                                                      |
| First visit                   | 16         | The writing                            | 17             | Yes                                                                                                                      |
| Margo's file                  | 44         | Margo's silence                        | 47             | Yes                                                                                                                      |
| Margo's silence noticed       | 47         | The vanish                             | 53             | Yes; the bag was placed on Day 46 under a plan ready since Day 30, so the trigger and the readiness are separately dated |
| Brad's vanish                 | 53         | Margo's guilt; the reading lands       | 54; 89         | Yes                                                                                                                      |
| Contact                       | 180        | Meeting                                | 214            | Yes                                                                                                                      |
| Margo's death                 | 214        | Survivors go in                        | 219            | Yes                                                                                                                      |
| Front page                    | 265        | Ally                                   | 266            | Yes                                                                                                                      |
| Panel aired                   | 325        | Panel burned; landlady looks           | 325 night; 326 | Yes                                                                                                                      |

**Sweep verdict: PASS.** No first-action date precedes its planned turn with a consequential outcome. Two thin locks: Margo Days 47 to 53; Ruby from Day 27. Both are open, computed and world-supplied. Both go to the attack first.



# D. THE OBJECTS

## D1. X, what Violet hid: the panel

A gilded alphabet panel. Oak, about 30 by 40 centimetres, black ground, twenty-six capitals and an ampersand in water gilding, a crack across one corner from the day the ceiling board came down, and a small maker's mark bottom right that is not a name: a monogram of the initials he lives under now. Made by Brad at Violet's bench on Tuesday nights over ten months, in a hand and at a standard he had never shown anyone in Havenbay, kept in the roof space over her racks because his flat and his van had to survive a search.

**Why it is damning to the three and not only to Brad (finding 7).** The panel is gilded lettering, and of the four people the letter is addressed to, exactly one gilds letters for a living. Violet's letter argued that it could not be his because it was better than he was; the three, holding Ruby's lie, Margo's cash and Liam's van question beside it, would not have followed her there. A crane driver, a nurse and an accountant cannot make it. That is the independent fact each of them holds, and it is why Brad could not leave it.

**Why it says "prepared exit" only when combined.** Alone it is a beautiful panel with a mark nobody knows. Beside the four's separate pieces it is one of the four making a name for himself somewhere else: Ruby's marathon told as a wedding (he lies about where he goes), Margo's pub books (he has been taking his income off paper for two years), Liam's question in the crane cab (he priced the van), and Violet's own expert judgement, which was wrong in the one way that matters: it is not Brad's hand, I taught him, he cannot do this. The genuine cage letter asked the four to pool everything odd they knew of one another. Pooled, the pieces name one man. That is why the letter had to go, and it is why the panel had to go with it: the mark on it is the mark he signs with now.

| # | Constraint (v8)                                                 | Panel                                                                                                             | Brush (Fable's seed)                                                   |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Unique physical object, cannot be posted or copied              | Yes: hand-gilded, one crack, one mark                                                                             | Yes                                                                    |
| 2 | Meaningless alone, damning beside what the four separately knew | Yes, as above                                                                                                     | <b>Fails:</b> it is hers; nothing the four know makes it mean anything |
| 3 | Not the motive                                                  | Yes: the debt is the motive; the panel accelerates                                                                | Yes                                                                    |
| 4 | Something Violet could plausibly have found                     | Yes: a leak, a ceiling board, a wrapped thing above her own racks                                                 | <b>Fails:</b> she made it; nothing was found                           |
| 5 | Something he wants                                              | Yes: the best thing he has ever made, in the self he could not show, and she wrote that he could not have made it | <b>Fails:</b> he has no use for her brush                              |
| 6 | Innocuous in a stranger's house four hundred miles away         | Yes: an alphabet thing on a lodger's wall; the mark is his own initials there                                     | Yes, barely: an odd brush                                              |
| 7 | Describable by Ally without holding it                          | Yes: she carried it round for a month asking whose hand; four people can describe it                              | Yes: from across the road                                              |

**Verdict:** the panel passes seven of seven. The brush passes four and fails 2, 4 and 5 as X. It also fails as the decoy (finding 1): she used it every day until she died, Liam saw it in her bucket on Day 2, and any decoy must be a thing none of the four can place after Day -19.

## D2. The decoy: the name board

The transom name board off the first boat the yard lifted after Liam bought in, eight years ago. Liam gave it to Violet; she had lettered the boat herself years before; it hung on a hook in her hall. All four have seen it there. None of them had been inside her house between Day -19 and Day 0: her life with them happened at the unit and the slip (row 5b). Brad took it off the hook at 22:20 on Day 0 and carried it out under his arm. On Day 19 the four find it in the cage and assume she took it down when she hid the letter. Nobody can say otherwise, because nobody was there to see the hook. Only its meaning is his.

**The false meaning, and the two truths it rides on.** The forged letter says: Liam gave her this board the day he bought in and told her that day how he had paid; she hung it where she would see it every morning and remember she had said nothing; the money in her tin is his, every quarter since, for her silence. Two claims in that letter are verifiable and true, and both are things Violet told only Brad: Liam owns a third of the yard (row 5), and there is a tin (row 1, and the whole room saw it go to the sister on Day 5). Liam confirms the first on Day 27. From that day the letter has earned the right to be believed about the third claim, which is the lie.

**Where it fails.** Only on the money. Margo alone knows the tin came from Violet's mother's house (row 2). She has it in her own hand in her own file, Day -1450. Violet did not get her own money wrong. So the letter is not Violet's.

**Why it cannot fail earlier or elsewhere.** Liam can deny paying her and cannot prove a negative. The sister does not know where the cash came from. Ruby never knew of the tin. Brad wrote nothing else that any of them could test.

## D3. The two cupboard letters, as claims

| Claim                   | Genuine (Day -19), read only by Brad                                                                         | Forged (Day 17), read by the four                                                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Certainty               | I think, and I may be wrong                                                                                  | I know, now                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Grounds                 | The ladder bolt undone; a panel in a hand she cannot place, hidden in her roof; a mark                       | The ladder: she had told Liam which ladder. The yard. The tin. The board                                                                                                         |
| Who                     | Nobody named. One line: it is not Brad's hand, I taught him, he cannot do this                               | Nobody named. Every line leans one way                                                                                                                                           |
| The thing beside it     | The panel: whose hand, whose mark                                                                            | The name board: Liam's gift, the day he bought in                                                                                                                                |
| How it could be written |                                                                                                              | The debt book, taken on Day 0, is pages of her cursive; years of Tuesday-night practice, burned; her pen, her paper, her bench. The finding-2 ruling: he secretly has the talent |
| Instruction             | Each of you write down everything odd you know of the other three from the last year, and read them together | Read this together, and be careful                                                                                                                                               |
| Mentions Brad           | Once, to clear him                                                                                           | Once, as the one she sent up the ladder, kindly                                                                                                                                  |
| Retrospective tells     |                                                                                                              | I know against I think; the letter kind to exactly one man; no panel, though four people in town saw her carrying one                                                            |

## D4. The motive, stated once

The money. Violet lent him the van and his start, cash, no paper, Day -2000, and on Day -110 told him she wanted it back for the lawyer. The exit was already built and the cash was already in it. From inside his head: a

debt follows a man who moves; nobody chases a debt to a man who died; a man who dies off Kestrel Head needs a grief the whole city will accept; and Violet's death is the one grief that makes his own read true, seven weeks later, to everyone including the police. The panel is not why. It is why it was that month.

## E. THE RULINGS (ALL EIGHT RULED, STEPHEN, 2026-08-30)

Eight questions. Seven are v8's queue plus the camera question added at the closure check; the eighth was the spine's own. Each is shown as asked, with what the spine needed and what would have broken, followed by **the ruling**. Recorded in the bible as R19 to R26.

| #          | Ruling                                                                                                                                                                                              | Effect on the spine                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1<br>(R19) | Accident stands; only new evidence of an act by a person reopens it                                                                                                                                 | As written                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 2<br>(R20) | High-risk missing, presumed in the water; search stands down in days; DNA and prints taken from the home on day one or two and kept indefinitely                                                    | As written                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 3<br>(R21) | Family or a person with a financial interest, after years; nobody here has either                                                                                                                   | As written                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 4<br>(R22) | Routine: any material posthumous document is examined before it is acted on                                                                                                                         | As written; the examination on Days 230 to 250 needs no one to say forgery                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 5<br>(R23) | Her carrier records yes; the app confirms an account and retains no content and no contacts; no tower request without an alleged offence                                                            | As written; closes the closure check's PARTLY                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 6<br>(R24) | Same site and known association link the files; linked means read together, not reclassified                                                                                                        | As written                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 7<br>(R25) | One camera at the car park entrance covering vehicles; none on the point or the path; a review pulls it and sees her car arrive alone                                                               | As written                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 8<br>(R26) | <b>Not the dead infant.</b> Brad lives under the genuine name of a man he killed three years before Violet, body never found, reported missing by his skipper, classified low risk, no sample (R16) | New node: the deckhand, the skipper, the constable. Rows added to A1, B1 (10a to 10d), B7 (R6, R6a, R6b), C2, C7, C8, C9, A5. v1.2 after finding 4: the deckhand lived aboard and the file names the boat, never Brad; and Brad's face is on no document under the name. Premise "Who Brad is" needs one line from Stephen |

The questions as they were put:

**1. What supports an accidental-fall finding on an unwitnessed death with head trauma, and what reopens it?** The spine needs: a secure house, a single impact consistent with the stair, modest alcohol, and a GP-recorded fall six weeks earlier are enough for a coroner to record accident after a competent post-mortem; and reopening requires new evidence of an act by a person, not a document expressing fear, not a friend's suicide, not a second death elsewhere. If it goes the other way (a written allegation reopens it): the finding reopens on Day 222, the police are then running an open homicide with a document examination inside it, and Ally arrives into an active case rather than a closed one. The premise's "they find nothing" survives; "Ally comes to it afterwards" does not.

**2. Missing-person status, search duration, and reference-sample practice when there is no body.** The spine needs: a vehicle, a message and a smashed watch at a known site make him high-risk missing presumed in the water; the search stands down within days; a DNA reference and lifted prints are taken from the home on the first or second day and retained indefinitely against a future body; the file stays missing, not dead, with no petition. If it goes the other way (no sample is taken for a presumed suicide): Day 333 has nothing to match him against and identification needs family DNA or his own confession. Fixable but slower and it loses the line the premise is built to deliver.

**3. Who can petition to have a missing man declared dead, and how fast?** The spine needs: only family or a person with a financial interest, after a waiting period measured in years, and nobody in this story has either the standing or the wish. If it goes the other way (a friend can, and quickly): Ruby might, out of kindness, to close his affairs; a declaration puts his death on paper and adds nothing to Brad's safety or danger. Cosmetic.

**4. Is authentication of a material posthumous document routine, discretionary, or only on express dispute?** The spine needs: any of the three. The letter is examined on Day 230 to 250 and passes as consistent with known samples on the same paper stock, because he was taught by her and wrote at her bench with her pen. The spine still needs to know which, because it decides whether the examination happens at Day 222 without anyone saying forgery (routine), or only because a detective chose to (discretionary), or not at all unless Margo's line is read as a dispute (on-dispute). If on-dispute: the examination may never happen, the file carries an unexamined letter, and Ally's later claim of forgery is untested rather than tested and wrong. Weaker, not fatal.

**5. What does a last-movements review reach on an apparent suicide when the device is lost: carrier records, app metadata, the prepaid connection?** The spine needs: her own carrier records (cell-site, data sessions), reached on request; the app provider confirming an account and retaining no content and no contact list; and no tower request, because a tower dump is an investigative tool for an offence and there is no offence. If it goes the other way (a tower request is routine for a death at that site): an unregistered prepaid pings the same cell at 22:50 on Day 214, the review has a second phone at the point, and the death is no longer an uncomplicated suicide on Day 225. That is the finding the closure check left PARTLY, and it is this ruling.

**6. Does a death at a known disappearance site automatically link the cases?** The spine needs: yes, and Del links them on Day 215 by hand anyway; linking means the files are read together, it does not mean either death is reclassified. If it goes the other way (no link): Del reaches the survivors four days later, when they come in themselves. Cosmetic.

**7. Camera coverage at the cliff and its approaches, and does a review pull it for an apparent suicide?** The spine needs: one camera at the car park entrance covering vehicles, pulled for Margo, showing her car arrive at 22:50 and nobody on foot, because the coast path from the landward side does not pass it; no camera on the point. If it goes the other way (a camera on the path or the point): it shows two figures at 23:00 on Day 214, and the spine fails at Day 218. If the review does not pull it at all: the tape expires Day 246 unwatched and the same nothing results, more cheaply. The spine wants it pulled, because a competent review that finds her alone is stronger than one that never looked.

**8. Identity documents: can a man build a usable second identity without an accomplice, in Havenbay's world?** As asked, the spine proposed a dead infant's birth record with no cross-check at issue. Stephen asked for the other routes (a synthetic identity from nothing; a living person's identity taken; an unidentified dead person's name under R16; a lawful name change, which fails because the record links it to

him; bought papers, which fail because a seller is an accomplice) and ruled a sixth: a missing man's genuine identity that Brad knows will never be used again, because Brad killed him. No seller, no register, no victim who can surface, and the file that holds the name is low risk in Del's own precinct under R16. It costs a prior, and it makes "the plan came first" literal.

*Also decided here without a ruling, and flagged as geography rather than process: Kestrel Head as the cliff, at the end of Kestrel Road beyond the lighthouse. It is a naming, and it costs an exterior the art system does not yet have.*

## F. PRE-FLIGHT: THE THIRTEEN OBJECTIONS

| #  | Objection                                                                           | Answer                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Result                                     |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| 1  | Why was the decisive material not found at the time?                                | Because it did not exist where anyone looked: the panel left in a rucksack on Day 53, the genuine letter was ash on Day 17, and the one fact that breaks the forgery was a promise Violet made Margo keep. Nobody was lazy: the scene, the PM, the search, the sample, the examination and the review all ran. | Pass                                       |
| 2  | Does the antagonist act in his own interest at every point?                         | Part C2: every action is coherent with what he wants, including the two compulsions, which are priced in B7.                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Pass                                       |
| 3  | Would a real person do the small thing this needs?                                  | Violet carries a panel round asking whose hand: she ranked handwriting out loud. Margo sits in the car until the hour. Ruby keeps the boxes. Tessa screenshots one strange line. Liam hands the tin over. Each is from the five.                                                                               | Pass                                       |
| 4  | Is the motive one an ordinary reader accepts?                                       | He owed her money he had already spent on leaving, and she had started asking for it.                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Pass                                       |
| 5  | Is any discovery a coincidence wearing a coat?                                      | The leak is the one accident in the spine and it is upstream of everything; the fishmonger, the platform woman and the landlady are found by asking, on air, in a serialised programme whose whole engine is that strangers answer. The landlady is a lodger's landlady, not a stranger who happened past.     | Pass, with the leak flagged for the attack |
| 6  | Does a reader with no context understand every word?                                | Cage, panel, name board, tin, ladder, cliff, train. "Gilding" needs one line. No procedure near the hook.                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Pass                                       |
| 7  | Can a reader hold the cast on one pass?                                             | Violet, then four names, then Del and Ally. Tessa and the landlady arrive one at a time and late. The solicitor, sister, fishmonger, clerk, café owner, skipper and lodger are functions with no names; the lodger's name is heard once, on Day 333, as the name Brad was arrested under.                      | Pass                                       |
| 8  | Is it clear what the crime is, immediately?                                         | A woman died on her stairs and her four friends were sent keys. Two of them are alive and afraid of each other.                                                                                                                                                                                                | Pass                                       |
| 9  | Can Ally source everything she says she knows?                                      | Part B6, rows 54 to 64. Nothing comes from the file.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Pass                                       |
| 10 | Does anything break its own rules?                                                  | Tips to Del never on air (rows 57, 60, 61, 63). The Tip Line keeps no metadata. All-party consent: Ally records nobody covertly. The letter is a letter, not a recording.                                                                                                                                      | Pass                                       |
| 11 | If the premise claims a route is the ONLY one, find the second route in the ledger. | The premise claims no wall. Every route to Del is open from Day 14 and each is computed in Part C to produce a note on a closed file. The second route to Brad is the download map (row 61), which gives a town and not a house, and it is used.                                                               | Pass                                       |
| 12 | Is the stake a body, freedom, family, identity or present danger?                   | Three bodies, a man's freedom, and a woman four hundred miles away who has told nobody but Ally.                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Pass                                       |

| #  | Objection                                      | Answer                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Result |
|----|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| 13 | Does anything decisive rest on a small number? | No. Ten minutes early is character, not evidence. Nothing turns on a time or a sum.                                                                                                                                    | Pass   |
| +  | Is the antagonist a person or a mechanism?     | A man who was the pet of the room for seven years and was cleverer than all of them, who built a self nobody was allowed to see, and who kept the one thing that proved it because she said he could not have made it. | Person |

**Score: 13 of 13, with objection 5's leak flagged for the step-3 attack.**

## G. WHAT FABLE MAY BE TOLD

*The redacted brief for step 4. Paste this block and nothing else. It contains what Ally has on the day she starts and what the city knows. It does not contain which of the four, what was behind the door beyond what the survivors say, where anyone is, or anything from Parts A to F.*

### **Brief for the opening of Episode One, working title The Friend They Mourned.**

You wrote the five as people. They are canon. Here is what happened to them, as Havenbay knows it, and what Ally holds on the morning she decides to make the episode.

**The public account.** Violet Moore, 44, signwriter, died at the foot of her own stairs on a Monday night about nine months ago. Head injury. Police attended, there was a post-mortem, a coroner recorded an accident. She had four close friends: Liam Bryce, Ruby Walker, Margo Rivera, Brad Collins. Two weeks after she died, each of them got a key in the post with a letter in her hand. The letter said she thought one of the four was planning to kill her, that she did not know which and might be wrong, that they were not to go to the police and why, and that what she had found was behind a door only the four of them could open. They went together on the Saturday. Behind the door was a second letter in her hand, longer, that said she knew, and a thing of hers beside it. The survivors will not say what the thing was, only that it was hers.

They worked the letter for weeks at Ruby's kitchen table. Seven weeks after the funeral Brad drove to Kestrel Head at night, left his phone on the seat with one message on it, and was never found. His watch was on the rocks. Police searched and stood down. Five months after that Margo Rivera's car was found in the same car park, ten minutes before eleven on the dashboard clock, and her body came into the harbour three days later. Police reviewed it and called it what it looked like: a woman who had blamed herself for the friend who went off the same cliff. She had a partner two hours up the coast that none of them knew about.

Liam and Ruby each went to the police within the week. Not to accuse. To say: I am frightened of him. I am frightened of her. The police looked, properly, for six weeks: the letters were examined and are hers, the solicitor confirmed she lodged them three weeks before she died, the coroner's finding stands, nothing was found. No further action. Ruby talked to the Gazette. The front page has the four of them at the wake.

**What Ally holds on day one.** The paper. A sergeant she trusts saying: we looked, properly, there's nothing. Ruby willing to talk. Liam not, yet. A Tip Line that has had nothing on this. No relationship to either survivor; she has never met them.

**What the opening must do.** Get the death and the keys inside the first forty-five seconds. Land on two living people taking each other apart in public over a dead woman's letter, and a podcaster who was not there for any of it. Under 330 words. Ally asks on microphone before she records anyone. Nothing in her voice claims to know what the police could not find.

**Do not invent:** which of the four; what the thing behind the door was; what the second letter said beyond that it said she knew and pointed, over weeks, at Liam; anything about where anyone is now; any procedure. If the opening needs a fact not in this brief, leave a gap and mark it.

No em dashes.

*End of brief. Everything above this line stays in this file.*